



United States
Attorney's Office
Eastern District of Pennsylvania



CEO of Local IT Staffing Company Charged With Tax and Bankruptcy Fraud

Monday, April 7, 2025

For Immediate Release

U.S. Attorney's Office, Eastern District of
Pennsylvania

Defendant Allegedly Failed to Pay IRS More Than \$2 Million in Required Withholdings From Employee Paychecks

PHILADELPHIA – United States Attorney David Metcalf announced that Thomas Stafford, 76, of Philadelphia, Pennsylvania, was arrested and charged by indictment with failing to collect and pay over trust fund taxes of Information Systems Staffing, Inc. ("ISS"), an information technology staffing company, and bankruptcy fraud.

The indictment alleges that, from the first quarter of 2019 to the fourth quarter of 2024, Stafford, the Chief Executive Officer and President of ISS, caused ISS to fail to pay approximately \$2,008,046.63 in trust fund taxes — the Social Security, Medicare, and federal income taxes that employers are required to withhold from their employees' paychecks and pay over to the Internal Revenue Service on a quarterly basis.

The indictment alleges that Stafford was responsible for collecting, accounting for, and paying to IRS the trust fund taxes of ISS because he controlled ISS's bank accounts (which were used by Stafford to pay hundreds of thousands of dollars in personal expenses), determined which expenses of ISS to pay, determined whether ISS should hire third-party entities to help ISS pay its trust fund taxes and other employment taxes, and obtained funds on behalf of ISS so that ISS could pay its expenses (including employee salaries).

The indictment further alleges that Stafford committed bankruptcy fraud in connection with a Chapter 13 bankruptcy case that he filed in the Eastern District of Pennsylvania in 2023. In the bankruptcy case, Stafford proposed a Chapter 13 plan that would pay creditors approximately \$750 per month over a five-year period. As alleged, in an attempt to pay his creditors less than what they were truly entitled to

receive, Stafford made false statements under penalty of perjury in which he understated his true income and failed to disclose that he controlled various properties owned by others.

If convicted, the defendant faces a maximum possible sentence of 130 years' imprisonment.

The case was investigated by the Internal Revenue Service Criminal Investigation and is being prosecuted by Assistant United States Attorney Francis A. Weber and Special Assistant United States Attorney Hannah J. McCollum.

An indictment, information, or criminal complaint is an accusation. A defendant is presumed innocent unless and until proven guilty.

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